ROUZE
e GAMES, TECHNOLOGY AND THE INTERNET
UNAPOLOGETICALLY MALE
SEARCH
your email
REGISTER FOR A CHANCE TO WIN $1000 GO
BUZZ | RAGE | E | SEX | PERFORM | POP | SPORTS | Y!.COM
FREE ROUZE E-MAIL | CARTOONS | PARTY PICS | TELL A FRIEND | CARS | MUSIC | GAMES | MAGAZINES | PICTORIALS

features

IS ONLINE HELP ON THE WAY?: ROUZE puts some major sites' customer service e-mail to the test
SEGA DREAMCAST GAME REVIEW: Marvel vs Capcom 2
SALLY TAYLOR PLUGS IN: The daughter of Carly Simon and James Taylor connects with her audience online
NEVER BUY SOFTWARE AGAIN: 'Pay-per-view' providers put it all online
N64 GAME REVIEW: Rally Challenge 2000
DIGITAL DIVA: A 'Net program jumps to TV; Jailcam inmates pretty in pink

AND WIN A TRIP TO SPRING BREAK!
BLOODHOUNDGANG.COM

e

Honey, I Shrunk the PDA

Personal digital assistants get even smaller

By Mike Talon



These days, it seems everything from cars to Pamela Anderson's breast implants are getting smaller. It should come as no surprise that personal digital assistants (PDAs) like the Palm Pilot are following suit. The latest—and smallest—is a product from Matsucom called the OnHand Wrist PC, available from www.onhandpc.com.

What is it?

The OnHand is a calculator watch-sized WristPC unit (available in transparent gray or black) that comes with a docking cradle to connect it to your PC or Mac, and a software bundle that contains the PC-to-OnHand connection software and some desktop applications. Matsucom also throws in two spare batteries—which the company claims will last about three months each—and complete instructions for both the hardware and software.

What does it do?

It basically does everything you'd expect a PDA to do. Software includes desktop versions of OnHand's scheduler, address book, to-do list, expense report and a few others. OnHand also synchronizes with most common personal information management software, including Microsoft Outlook, ACT, Goldmine and many others. That means you don't need to use the supplied applications if you have another program you're already familiar with.

The device can also use an infrared interface to communicate with either other OnHand units or your computer. An add-on sold on the OnHand Web site converts the unit from a watch into a clip-on.

Does it work?

For our ROUZE real-world test, we took the unit to our recent All Greek Ski Weekend in Reno, and put it through its paces tracking a host of constantly changing events and information. The scheduler was able to keep track of the varied events, reminding us with alarms when we were late for one thing or another. Additionally, the address book and notes were quite handy for keeping track of who was doing what.

By using the joystick-like navigation tool and the simple buttons on the unit to get around, it was pretty easy to get all the information from Outlook into the unit, and then keep track of 10,000 college kids, 20 events, six major parties and three marathon blackjack sessions—even though it wasn't quite fast enough to count cards at

the tables.

What's next?
Matsucom will introduce new features into the OnHand system over the next year or so, including Internet connectivity and advanced software. In addition, the company plans to make it possible to beam information to and from existing devices such as the Palm Pilot. Since the system has a development kit, you can bet independent programmers will make a ton of software to download and use as well.

What does it cost?
The OnHand's suggested retail price of $249 places it well within the price range of similar devices. If you're not an experienced PDA user, it will take some getting used to, but if you're always on the go and seem to always lose your Palm Pilot stylus, the OnHand is perfect.

e-mail this story to a friend:

SEND

Affiliates | Auto Guide | Tell a friend | Shopping
Party with Rouze | Games | Advertise With Us
Cartoons | About | Feedback



PRIVACY POLICY | TERMS and CONDITIONS | COPYRIGHT

© 2000 rouze.com